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What is Cybersecurity?

The practice of protecting our digital lives from attack



01

Simple definition

Cybersecurity is the practice of protecting computers, networks, systems, and data from digital attacks, damage, and unauthorized access.



02

What does it protect?

- Personal information and identity
- Money and banking details
- Photos, files, and emails
- Devices, accounts, and networks



03

Why is it important?

We shop, bank, work, and communicate online daily. Without protection, attackers can steal your money, identity, and privacy — often in seconds.



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How Does Cybersecurity Work?

Five layers of protection working together



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Passwords

Your first line of defense — only you should know them.



02

Two-factor authentication

A second proof of identity, such as a code sent to your phone.



03

Encryption

Scrambles your data so only the intended person can read it.



01

Updates

Patch security holes before attackers can exploit them.



02

Safe behavior

Think before you click — most attacks target people, not machines.



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The 3 Main Goals of Security

The CIA Triad — the foundation of all security



01

Confidentiality

Only the right people can access your data.

Example: your medical records stay private, seen only by you and your doctor.



02

Integrity

Data cannot be altered without permission.

Example: no one can quietly change your bank balance or exam results.



03

Availability

Systems and data work when you need them.

Example: your banking app is online whenever you need to pay.



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Authentication vs Authorization

Two similar-sounding questions — very different answers



"Who are you?"

Proving your identity before you get access.

- Password or PIN
- Fingerprint / Face ID
- 2FA code

Like showing your ID at the entrance.



"What can you do?"

Deciding what you're allowed to do once inside.

- Admin vs. regular user rights
- Guest Wi-Fi with limited access

Like a keycard that opens only certain doors.



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Threats, Vulnerabilities & Risks

Three key words — and how they connect



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Threat

A potential danger that can cause harm.

Example: a hacker trying to steal customer data.



02

Vulnerability

A weakness a threat can exploit.

Example: an outdated app with a known security flaw.



03

Risk

The chance of harm actually happening.

Example: a weak password + a phishing email = high risk of account theft.



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Digital Identity & Zero Trust

Why "never trust, always verify" is the modern standard



Your digital identity

Everything that represents you online:

- Accounts and usernames
- Email addresses
- Devices and their IDs
- Online behavior patterns

If stolen, attackers can pretend to be you.



Zero Trust

Never trust something automatically just because it looks familiar.

- Verify every login and request
- Don't trust links or devices by default
- Check sender addresses carefully
- Assume attackers are already inside



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What Makes a Strong Password?

Three rules: long, unique, hard to guess



Strong passwords are

- Long — at least 12 characters
- Unique — different for every account
- Hard to guess — no names or birthdays
- A mix of letters, numbers, and symbols



Weak vs strong

Weak: john123 · password · iloveyou

- Blue!River7#Tiger!Moon
- Tr3e-H0use!Candle-92



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Common Password Attacks

How attackers break passwords — and why reuse is dangerous



01

Brute force

Software tries millions of combinations automatically until one works. A short password falls in seconds; a long one takes years.



02

Password reuse

One password everywhere means a single leak can break every account you own — email, banking, social media.



03

Credential stuffing

Attackers take passwords leaked from one website and automatically try them on all your other accounts.

2FA & Password Managers

Two simple tools that block most account takeovers



Two-factor authentication

Logging in requires two proofs: your password, and a code on your phone.

- 1. Something you know — your password
- 2. Something you have — a code on your phone

Even if your password is stolen, attackers still can't get in without your phone.



Password managers

A secure app that:

- Creates strong, unique passwords for every account
- Stores and fills them automatically
- Protects them with one master password

You only ever remember one password.



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Common Password Mistakes

Habits that quietly put your accounts at risk



Using the same password everywhere — one leak compromises everything



Sharing passwords with friends, family, or coworkers



Using easy personal information — pet names, birthdays, favorite teams



Weak security questions — answers like a maiden name are often public



Writing passwords on sticky notes or in plain-text files



Never changing passwords after a data breach notification



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What is Phishing?

The most common way attackers trick people



Simple definition

Phishing is when attackers pretend to be a trusted person or company to trick you into revealing sensitive information — passwords, card numbers, personal data.



How attackers trick people

They exploit trust and urgency:

- Fake emails from "your bank"
- A "friend" in trouble
- "You've won a prize!"
- "Your account will be closed!"

The goal: make you panic and click before you think.



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Types of Phishing

The same scam, delivered through different channels



Email phishing

Fake emails posing as banks, delivery companies, or well-known services like Netflix or PayPal.



SMS / smishing

Text messages with malicious links — fake package alerts or bank warnings.



Social media scams

Fake profiles, investment fraud, and hijacked accounts messaging your friends.



Vishing

Voice phishing — scam calls posing as tech support, banks, or government agencies.

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How to Recognize Phishing

Six red flags to check before you click anything



Urgency — "Act now or your account will be closed!"



Strange links — hover to reveal the real address before clicking



Unknown senders — or slightly misspelled addresses like paypa1.com



Requests for passwords, codes, or personal details — real companies never ask this way



Spelling and grammar mistakes



Too-good-to-be-true offers — free money, prizes, or dream jobs



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Fake Websites & QR Phishing

Phishing has moved beyond your inbox



Fake websites

Attackers copy real login pages to steal credentials. You click a link to "your bank," the page looks perfect, you enter your password — and it's gone.

Type addresses yourself or use bookmarks.



QR phishing (quishing)

Malicious QR codes leading to fake websites, found on parking meters, menus, posters, and emails.

Preview the link before opening; never enter passwords from an unknown code.

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Spear Phishing

Targeted attacks are far more convincing



Why it's more dangerous

Regular phishing goes randomly to millions.

Spear phishing targets you specifically — attackers research your name, job, colleagues, and habits to build a convincing, personalized message.



An employee gets an email that looks like it's from their boss:

"I'm in a meeting — buy 5 gift cards for a client RIGHT NOW and send me the codes."

The address is one letter off. Urgency stops verification.

RESULT: THE COMPANY LOSES \$500

What is Malware?

Malicious software — built to harm, spy, or steal



Simple definition

Malware (malicious software) is any program designed to harm your device, steal your data, or take control of your system.



What can it do?

- Steal passwords and banking details
- Delete or encrypt your files
- Spy on everything you type
- Use your device to attack others
- Slow down or destroy your system

Types of Malware

Four common kinds you should know



Virus

Attaches to legitimate files and spreads when you open them.



Trojan

Disguised as a normal app or file. You install it yourself — it opens a backdoor for attackers.



Worm

Spreads on its own across networks — no action needed from you.



Ransomware

Encrypts your files and demands payment to unlock them.



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Spyware & Keyloggers

The silent spies hiding in infected devices



Spyware

Runs silently in the background, secretly collecting:

- Browsing habits
- Login credentials
- Screenshots and webcam access
- Location data



Keyloggers

A type of spyware that records every key you press:

- Every password you type
- Every message you send
- Every card number you enter

All quietly sent to the attacker.

How Malware Gets In

Five common infection routes — all avoidable



Fake apps

Malicious apps disguised as popular games or tools, often outside official app stores.



Unknown files & attachments

Opening downloads or email attachments from strangers.



Unsafe websites

Drive-by downloads that infect you just by visiting a compromised page.



Cracked software

"Free" pirated programs are among the most common malware carriers.

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How to Stay Safe Online

The 5 Golden Rules

 Use strong and unique passwords

 Turn on 2FA

 Think before clicking

 Keep your devices updated

 Download only from trusted sources

> Thank you – stay safe online.